A Walk Through the Tent

Exodus 25–27 · Exodus 30

The big idea: The holy God came to live in the middle of his people's camp. Every piece of the tent taught the way to God: one gate, the altar first, washing, a guarded veil, and a mercy seat over the law Israel could not keep.

Before you meet: Read

Exodus 25:1–22 | Exodus 26:31–33 | Exodus 27:1–8

Open (5 minutes)

Think of a home where you always felt welcome. What made it feel that way?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"And let them make me a _____, that I may _____ in their midst." *(Exodus 25:8)*

The craftsmen told Moses, "The people bring much more than _____," so Moses told everyone to stop giving. *(Exodus 36:5–7)*

Of Bezalel the artist, God said, "I have filled him with the _____ of God, with ability and intelligence." *(Exodus 31:3)*

"There I will _____ with you, and from above the _____ seat, from between the two cherubim that are on the ark of the testimony, I will speak with you." *(Exodus 25:22)*

Discuss

1. Exodus spends thirteen chapters on a tent, more than Genesis spends on the flood or on creation. Why do you think God cared so much about the details of his dwelling place? *Exodus 25:8–9, 40*

2. Walk through the tent from the gate to the ark: one gate, the altar, the basin, the veil, the mercy seat. What does that order teach about coming to God? *Exodus 27:1–2; 30:17–21; 26:31–33*

3. Inside the ark was the law Israel would break. Over it was the mercy seat, and over that was God's presence. What does that picture say to you? *Exodus 25:16–22*

Memory verse

"And let them make me a sanctuary, that I may dwell in their midst."

Exodus 25:8

Pray

Thank God that he wants to live with his people, and that Jesus is the gate, the sacrifice, and the way through the veil.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 19

A Walk Through the Tent

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Exodus 25:1–22 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Exodus 28, 33:12–23, and 40:16–38).

Main points to land

1. The tabernacle was God's house, his dwelling place (mishkan) in the center of the camp. It is a big step toward the goal of the whole story since Eden: God living with his people (Exodus 25:8).
2. God gave the pattern, the people gave willingly, and the Spirit gave Bezalel his skill. Grace turns freed slaves into generous givers and beauty into worship (Exodus 31:3; 36:5–7).
3. The layout teaches the way to God: one gate, the altar of sacrifice first, washing, then a veil guarded by cherubim. In the inner room the mercy seat covered the law Israel could not keep (Exodus 25:16–22).

Core doctrine to teach

The Holiness of God CORE DOCTRINE 10 OF 26

God is holy. He is utterly pure and set apart from everything sinful and ordinary, and his glory is beyond us. That is why the tabernacle had a curtain and why sinners could not simply walk into his presence. Only a sacrifice and a priest could open the way. *Exodus 15:11; Leviticus 19:2; Isaiah 6:1–5; Hebrews 12:28–29*

Answer key (Observe)

1. sanctuary; dwell
2. enough
3. Spirit
4. meet; mercy

Questions people will ask

Does every peg and color of the tabernacle have a hidden meaning?

Hebrews calls the tent a copy and shadow of the heavenly things (8:5), and it explains the big pieces: the veil, the high priest, the blood, the Most Holy Place. Some readers have found a symbol in every hook, which goes beyond what Scripture says. The details mattered because God gave them, but the meaning lives in the main pieces and their order. Keep the group on the way to God through Christ.

Closing prayer

Holy God, thank you that you chose to live among your people, and that you made a way for sinners to come near. Thank you that Jesus is the door and the sacrifice, and that his blood opened the way through the veil. Amen.